

Declamation Competition (English / Urdu)

Participants deliver a persuasive, prepared speech on a given or chosen topic in either English or Urdu, judged on content, delivery, and impact.

Rules & Specifications

Participation	Individual participation only. Participants must declare their language (English or Urdu) at registration; each language track is judged separately.
Topic	Topics are announced by the organizing committee at least 5 days before the event; extempore/impromptu sub-topics may also be assigned on stage at the judges' discretion.
Time Limit	Maximum 5 minutes per participant. A warning bell rings at 4 minutes and a final bell at 5 minutes.
Presentation Rules	Speeches must be memorized or delivered with minimal reference to notes reading directly from a script is not permitted.
Judging Criteria	• Content, Structure & Relevance — 30% • Language Command & Vocabulary — 25% • Delivery, Tone & Body Language — 25% • Audience Impact & Time Management — 20%
Conduct & Penalties	Exceeding the time limit results in marks deduction. Plagiarized or offensive content leads to disqualification.

General Rules — Applicable to This Category

- **Strict Punctuality** — Teams must report to their arena, lab, stage, or table 15 minutes before their scheduled heat or session. Late arrival results in automatic forfeit.
- **Fair Play** — Abusive behavior, argument with judges leads to immediate disqualification.
- **Content & Decorum** — Content must remain free of hate speech, personal attacks on individuals or political parties, and any offensive or discriminatory material; violations result in point deductions or disqualification.
- **Judge's Decision** — The decision of the judges is indisputable and final.

These rules are issued by the Capital Youth Expo organizing committee and apply alongside the master rulebook. The committee reserves the right to modify rules, time limits, or format if necessary. Judges' decisions are final and non-contestable.